

COACH GUIDE

Self-Knowledge & Handling Pressure

SCIENTIFIC BASIS

- Ntoumanis et al. (2021): autonomy-supportive coaching increases intrinsic motivation and well-being
- Zuber & Conzelmann (2014): self-knowledge in young athletes predicts performance under pressure
- Deci & Ryan (1985, 2017): self-determination theory, sense of competence and relatedness
- Hanton et al. (2009): mental preparation for worst-case scenarios reduces competitive anxiety

OBJECTIVE

Players record their personal values, recognize energy sources in their team, and mentally prepare for pressure. This forms the foundation for the rest of the track.

GUIDANCE PER EXERCISE**1 Personal values compass**

8 min

Have players individually rank the six values. No right or wrong answer. Ask afterward: which value surprised you the most?

2 Energy giver vs energy drainer

10 min

Players work individually, discuss afterward in pairs. Note: this is about situations and behavior, not about tearing down teammates.

3 Worst case best case

12 min

Link this to a concrete, recognizable game situation. Discuss as a group: what makes the most likely scenario manageable?

COACH TIP

Lead by example: briefly share your own worst case best case for an important moment in your coaching career.

WATCH OUT FOR

Don't force anyone to share out loud. Writing alone already has value. Don't force vulnerability.

COACH GUIDE

My Role & Team First

SCIENTIFIC BASIS

- Bruner et al. (2021): role clarity in teams is linked to higher team cohesion
- Eys et al. (2015): role acceptance predicts team satisfaction and effort
- Carron & Eys (2012): team cohesion as the strongest predictor of team performance over time
- Holt et al. (2020): peer feedback increases self-insight in youth athletes
- Tod et al. (2011): public commitment, such as signing, increases adherence to agreements

OBJECTIVE

Players recognize their natural role, practice giving and receiving feedback, and record their personal contribution to the team contract as the closer of the track.

GUIDANCE PER EXERCISE**1 Role compass**

10 min

Have players score individually, then discuss as a group which roles are over- or under-represented in the team.

2 Feedback round trio

15 min

Split into trios. Each player gets two minutes of feedback from the other two in turn: one strength, one growth point. Coach models the format first.

3 Reflection after feedback

5 min

Individually complete: what do you take with you, what will you do with it.

4 Sign the team contract

15 min

Each player writes three personal promises and signs. Collect the sheets and turn them into one visible team document.

COACH TIP

Keep the signed contracts and bring them back midseason as a check-in moment.

WATCH OUT FOR

For the feedback round: pair trios deliberately, avoid combinations with existing tension without guidance.